

Syd Polk

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SUMMARY

Seasoned software developer and manager with experience in all aspects of software development. Amateur baseball analyst. Part-time profession musician.

EDUCATION

Rice University, Houston, TX - Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science.

BASEBALL

- Project Scoresheet 1987-1990 – Scorer for Houston Astros 1987-1988, San Francisco Giants/Oakland Athletics 1988-1990
- Project Retrosheet 2000 – Input games into Retrosheet system from original press scoresheets for Houston Astros, 1973 and 1974 seasons.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

Indeed, Inc., Austin, TX.

Senior Software Engineer, April 2016-present.

- Participated in hundreds of onsite interviews for potential candidates to work at Indeed.

Senior Software Engineer, Mobile Applications, April 2022-date.

- Developed user-facing native features using SwiftUI and GraphQL for [Indeed's Job Search app](#).
 - The number of opt outs of all push notifications per day has dropped 30% since Native Push Notification Preferences was rolled out in January 2024.
 - Engagement between employers and job seekers using Indeed's messaging has increased 9% since the native messaging was rolled out in late 2024.
- Established an on-call system for mobile engineers based on a Datadog-based monitoring system for our mobile native applications.
 - ~30 engineers in on-call rotation
 - Developed Datadog logging and metrics in the iOS Job Search app.
 - Developed runbooks and dashboards as resources during on-call events.
 - The average time from when an outage started until the team was notified dropped from >120 minutes to < 5 minutes.
- Developed integration with Indeed's A/B testing system in the IOS Job Search app, enabling A/B tests of features and improvements.

Site Reliability Engineer (1 quarter rotation), April-July, 2021.

Software Engineer, Job Search Native API – November 2018-April 2022.

- Developed and evangelized GraphQL technology within Indeed.
- Split a small but important service from our main job search webserver for use as a microservice.
 - Service handles several million requests a week that would have otherwise been handled by the main Indeed server, decreasing request latency and memory pressure. Handles 100M+ requests/month with an internal latency average < 100ms, and availability 99.0%
- Developed high-volume client logging library using Kafka and Avro that can handle tens of millions of logs per day from the GlassDoor native application.

Software Engineer, Job Search Front End – April 2016-November 2018.

- A/B testing of various features on the job viewing web page; increased user engagement 5-8%.
- Made build system improvements that resulting in our builds being 25-30% faster.

Mozilla, Inc., Mountain View, CA (remote).

Technical Lead, Platform QA, April 2014-April 2016.

- Developed Black Box test plan for Firefox's implementation of WebRTC.
- Wrote automation for regression testing of Firefox's streaming playback of web content, with and without DRM.

Klink LLC, Austin, Texas.

Mac OS X Programmer, August 2013-April 2014.

- Used Objective C, Python and PyObjC to develop user interface for cloud syncing application.
- Used Python to implement syncing via RESTful interfaces.
- Reduced open bug count by 80%.

Spawn Labs, Austin, Texas.

QA & Release Engineering Manager, September 2012-August 2013.

- Wrote overall test plan for Spawn's cloud gaming service.
- Worked to establish CI/CD builds for each of the different pieces of the service, which were all based on different technologies.
- Increased performance of the build of the main kernel 100% by automating application of kernel patches.

Rock Systems, Durango, Colorado (remote).

Consultant – iOS Development, April 2012-August 2012.

- Identified and fixed 80+ defects in Airborne Media Group's **Audio Air** iOS app (now discontinued), including many crashing defects that would have been triggered within 5 minutes of launch.
- Version 1.3 shipped in the App Store in September 2012.

Coverity Software (now Synopsis), San Francisco, California (remote).

Senior QA Manager and QA Architect, July 2008-May 2012

- Managed 3 onshore and 8 offshore resources.
- Ported vulnerability verification system from Jenkins to a Perl-based custom implementation.
 - Changed backend database system to Coverity's new Defect Manager.
 - Total time to verify new builds improved 80% amortized over 8 platforms.

Lombardi Software (now IBM), Austin, Texas.

QA Manager, May 2006-June 2008

- Managed 3 onshore and 15 offshore resources.
- Provided test plans and reports for 4 releases of Lombardi's TeamWorks.
- Oversaw team as it developed test plans and resources for Lombardi's Saas Blueprint
 - Developed DevOps plan and managed 1 DevOps engineer.

Apple Computer (now Apple, Inc.), Cupertino, California.

Xcode Tools QA & Integration Manager, May 2001-April 2006

- Managed 3-5 engineers.
- Developed a system of tracking release manifests for Mac OS X and Xcode releases, reducing accidental inclusion or exclusion of files in final releases to zero for 8 software updates in a row.
- Worked as internal evangelist for the Xcode Tools group, including working with teams to do work for the Intel transition while the transition was still confidential inside of Apple.
- Developed a system to analyze problems and impact of new compilers for three consecutive releases.
 - Verified that 1200+ C/C++/Objective C/Objective C++ projects compiled and built correctly.
 - Built versions of Mac OS X with new versions of the compiler, insuring that installers and installations worked properly.
 - Reduced time to build a Mac OS build with new GCC builds from 5 days to 1 in the test lab, allowing many more new versions of the compiler to be verified.
 - Developed an automated build failure diagnosis system that eliminated redundant build failure analysis.
 - Total time to verify a new compiler for a new version of the OS went down from 8 months to 3 months.

Red Hat, Inc./Cygnus Solutions, Sunnyvale, California.

Engineering Manager, November 1997-May 2001

- Managed Source-Navigator, Cygnus' IDE which allowed for sophisticated analysis of source code.
 - Managed 4 remote software engineers, 1 customer support technician, and 1 technical writer.
- Manager GCC and GDB engineers
 - Managed total of 15 remote engineers.
 - Worked with project managers and other engineering managers to allocate engineers to various

contracts and products.

- Project manager for two projects, Code Fusion and Gnu Pro, involving all of the engineering teams in the project.
 - Provided estimates of work, tracked schedules, provided feedback to engineers.
 - Took over both projects when they were very late.
 - Developed new schedules. Projects then shipped within parameters of the new schedule.

Sun Microsystems Laboratories (now Oracle Laboratories), Mountain View, California.

Member of Technical Staff, March 1996 to November 1997

- Built and developed native features for Mac OS and Windows 32 versions of Tcl/Tk.

Claris Corporation (now Claris International), Santa Clara, California / **StyleWare, Inc.**, Houston, Texas

Software Engineer, December 1987-March 1996

- FileMaker Pro for Mac and Windows
- AppleWorks GS for the Apple IIGS.

SKILLS

Claude, Codex, Swift, SwiftUI, UIKit, Combine, Xcode, Bash/shell scripting, Java, GraphQL, Apollo Federation, Python, Spring, Spring Boot, Objective C, RESTful APIs, JavaScript, Soy, HTML, CSS, Django, C, SQL, Perl, Tcl, Ruby, Eclipse, MacOS, iOS, Unix, Linux, Windows, Visual Studio, cvs, Subversion, Perforce, git, Bitkeeper, Mercurial, gcc, Jenkins, VMWare, Cocoa, Bugzilla, JIRA, yocto, repo, vagrant, VirtualBox, Marionette, hobo, Datadog, Terraform, Kubernetes, Avro, Kafka, Docker, make, Pascal, Assembly Language, Agile, Kanban, Waterfall

ONLINE PUBLICATIONS

[Recruited By Tech](#) – a blog about interviewing for jobs in the tech sector.

[Middle-class Tech](#) – a newsletter about my life in the tech sector.

[Not Your Ordinary Computer Geek](#) – Personal blog, where I reflect on many life experiences, including baseball.